Investigator Brief

The first 10 cases · Demo Client

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Engagement	DEMO-0009
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Prepared by	ProQuant Analytics · info@proquantanalytics.com
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Executive summary

Demonstration. Synthetic company, customers and transactions generated for illustration. No real person or business is described.

This brief writes up the first 10 cases of the queue of 346 for the fraud team. Each one gives the facts, why it was raised, the transactions and what to check next. **An alert is a reason to look, never proof of fraud.** In a suspected takeover the customer is the victim, so call them on a known number. In every other case, ask compliance before you contact anyone, and never tip off the subject of a possible report; compliance decides what is reported.

Priority	Type	Cases	Exposure (USD)
P1	Account takeover	3	24,563
P1	Card testing	2	3,376
P1	Merchant collusion	1	26,100
P1	Mule activity	1	409,751
P1	Structuring	1	37,523
P2	Account takeover	8	17,448
P2	Unusual behaviour	108	540,196
P3	Account takeover	9	5,289
P3	Unusual behaviour	213	96,973

Source: tables/case_queue.csv

Methodology

Cases group the alerts by suspected ring, then suspected merchant, then account. P1: a ring, a merchant or an exposure above the limit in the configuration. Scores run from 0 to 999; the alert threshold in this run is 949.

Results

Q-0001 · Mule activity

P1 | Ring RING-071 | 138 transactions | 12 account(s) | USD 409,751 | max score 997

Seen: 2026-08-24 10:32:18 to 2026-09-29 19:49:09. **Already confirmed:** 3. **Seen by the current rules:** 123.

Why it was raised: Money received in the last 24 hours; Accounts seen on this device; Money forwarded within a day from a shared device; Young account forwards most of what it received.

Time	Account	Channel	Payee	USD	Ctry	IP	Device	Score
2026-08-24 10:32:18	A-02989	transfer	B-99001	3,923	TR	SA	D-M00002	997
2026-08-24 11:54:25	A-03000	transfer	B-99001	1,889	TR	SA	D-M00001	997
2026-08-24 13:40:29	A-02999	transfer	B-01351	328	DE	DE	D-002999	721
2026-08-24 14:25:47	A-02996	transfer	B-99001	2,017	TR	AE	D-M00001	997
2026-08-24 15:20:24	A-02993	transfer	B-99001	3,167	TR	SA	D-M00002	997
2026-09-29 17:24:14	A-02997	transfer	B-99001	3,899	TR	GB	D-M00002	997
2026-09-29 19:36:16	A-02995	transfer	B-99001	4,614	TR	AE	D-M00002	997
2026-09-29 19:49:09	A-03000	transfer	B-99001	1,919	TR	SA	D-M00001	997

Source: tables/alert_queue.csv (138 transactions, 8 shown)

What to check

- Who opened these accounts, and did they use the same documents or address?
- Where does the money come from? Ask the sending banks whether the senders are victims.
- Who owns the beneficiary? Has it received money from other customers?

Suggested next step: Hold outgoing transfers, review KYC of the linked accounts, consider a suspicious-activity report (compliance decides).

Finding: _____ Outcome: Confirmed fraud / Not fraud / Escalated Investigator and date: _____

Q-0002 · Structuring

P1 | Account A-00592 | 9 transactions | 1 account(s) | USD 37,523 | max score 999

Seen: 2026-08-21 14:44:39 to 2026-08-26 11:56:24. **Already confirmed:** 2. **Seen by the current rules:** 4.

Why it was raised: Repeated amounts under the threshold (30 days); Value in the last 24 hours; Transactions in the last 24 hours; Repeated amounts just under the reporting threshold.

Time	Account	Channel	Payee	USD	Ctry	IP	Device	Score
2026-08-21 14:44:39	A-00592	transfer	B-83328	9,650	AE	AE	D-000592	997
2026-08-21 16:07:09	A-00592	ecom	M-0395	27	AE	AE	D-000592	980
2026-08-21 16:52:27	A-00592	ecom	M-0332	58	AE	AE	D-000592	985
2026-08-22 15:10:46	A-00592	transfer	B-00455	147	AE	AE	D-000592	988
2026-08-24 12:44:08	A-00592	transfer	B-83328	9,098	AE	AE	D-000592	997
2026-08-24 17:58:51	A-00592	ecom	M-0405	38	AE	AE	D-000592	957
2026-08-25 11:26:18	A-00592	transfer	B-83328	9,142	AE	AE	D-000592	999
2026-08-26 11:56:24	A-00592	transfer	B-83328	9,336	AE	AE	D-000592	998

Source: tables/alert_queue.csv (9 transactions, 8 shown)

What to check

- What is the stated purpose of the payments, and does it fit the customer?
- Who is the beneficiary?
- Is a report due? Compliance decides.

Suggested next step: Ask for the purpose of the payments; compliance decides whether a report is due.

Finding: _____ Outcome: Confirmed fraud / Not fraud / Escalated Investigator and date: _____

Q-0003 · Merchant collusion

P1 | Merchant M-0391 | 76 transactions | 25 account(s) | USD 26,100 | max score 996

Seen: 2026-08-22 03:38:00 to 2026-09-22 02:58:00. **Already confirmed:** 18. **Seen by the current rules:** 0.

Why it was raised: Young merchant; Round amount; Round amount at night at a young merchant; Between midnight and 05:00.

Time	Account	Channel	Payee	USD	Ctry	IP	Device	Score
2026-08-22 03:38:00	A-00504	ecom	M-0391	1,000	AE	AE	D-000504	983
2026-08-23 00:06:00	A-00986	ecom	M-0391	1,000	SA	SA	D-000986	980
2026-08-24 01:19:00	A-02636	ecom	M-0391	200	SA	SA	D-002636	991
2026-08-24 02:05:00	A-00786	ecom	M-0391	500	SA	SA	D-000786	992
2026-08-24 02:38:00	A-01724	ecom	M-0391	100	AE	AE	D-001724	971
2026-09-21 04:51:00	A-02488	ecom	M-0391	100	SA	SA	D-002488	956
2026-09-22 01:25:00	A-00988	ecom	M-0391	200	IN	IN	D-000988	983
2026-09-22 02:58:00	A-00986	ecom	M-0391	200	SA	SA	D-000986	977

Source: tables/alert_queue.csv (76 transactions, 8 shown)

What to check

- What does the merchant sell, and does the onboarding file fit these amounts?
- Do the same customers come back? Are they related to the owner?
- Should settlement be held while this is reviewed?

Suggested next step: Review the merchant's onboarding file and settlements; consider a settlement hold.

Finding: _____ Outcome: Confirmed fraud / Not fraud / Escalated Investigator and date: _____

Q-0004 · Account takeover

P1 | Account A-00747 | 6 transactions | 1 account(s) | USD 12,549 | max score 999

Seen: 2026-09-03 15:22:33 to 2026-09-03 16:41:37. **Already confirmed:** 5. **Seen by the current rules:** 3.

Why it was raised: Value in the last 24 hours; Transactions in the last hour; New payee, large for this account, on a recently new device; Transactions in the last 24 hours.

Time	Account	Channel	Payee	USD	Ctry	IP	Device	Score
2026-09-03 15:22:33	A-00747	ecom	M-0418	2,037	IN	BR	D-F00005	997
2026-09-03 15:27:23	A-00747	ecom	M-0359	1,678	IN	BR	D-F00005	997
2026-09-03 15:45:16	A-00747	ecom	M-0215	822	IN	BR	D-F00005	998
2026-09-03 16:13:08	A-00747	transfer	B-79118	3,316	BR	BR	D-F00005	999
2026-09-03 16:33:39	A-00747	ecom	M-0109	3,166	IN	BR	D-F00005	999
2026-09-03 16:41:37	A-00747	transfer	B-77892	1,531	BR	BR	D-F00005	999

Source: tables/alert_queue.csv (6 transactions, 6 shown)

What to check

- Does the customer recognise the device and the payments? Use a known number, not one given in the session.
- Was the password or the phone number changed before the first payment?
- Can the payments still be recalled?

Suggested next step: Call the customer on a known number, freeze the new device, reverse what can be reversed.

Finding: _____ Outcome: Confirmed fraud / Not fraud / Escalated Investigator and date: _____

Q-0005 · Account takeover

P1 | Account A-01596 | 2 transactions | 1 account(s) | USD 6,967 | max score 970

Seen: 2026-09-21 04:27:42 to 2026-09-25 16:33:42. **Already confirmed:** 0. **Seen by the current rules:** 2.

Why it was raised: New payee, large for this account, on a recently new device; Amount against the largest so far; First payment to this payee; IP country differs from the transaction.

Time	Account	Channel	Payee	USD	Ctry	IP	Device	Score
2026-09-21 04:27:42	A-01596	transfer	B-01358	2,620	PK	AE	D-001596	970
2026-09-25 16:33:42	A-01596	transfer	B-00992	4,347	PK	AE	D-001596	956

Source: tables/alert_queue.csv (2 transactions, 2 shown)

What to check

- Does the customer recognise the device and the payments? Use a known number, not one given in the session.
- Was the password or the phone number changed before the first payment?
- Can the payments still be recalled?

Suggested next step: Call the customer on a known number, freeze the new device, reverse what can be reversed.

Finding: _____ Outcome: Confirmed fraud / Not fraud / Escalated Investigator and date: _____

Q-0006 · Account takeover

P1 | Account A-02375 | 1 transactions | 1 account(s) | USD 5,047 | max score 969

Seen: 2026-09-30 10:55:55 to 2026-09-30 10:55:55. **Already confirmed:** 0. **Seen by the current rules:** 1.

Why it was raised: Dormant account wakes up with a large payment; Amount against the largest so far; Dormant days before this; First payment to this payee.

Time	Account	Channel	Payee	USD	Ctry	IP	Device	Score
2026-09-30 10:55:55	A-02375	ecom	M-0394	5,047	AE	AE	D-002375	969

Source: tables/alert_queue.csv (1 transactions, 1 shown)

What to check

- Does the customer recognise the device and the payments? Use a known number, not one given in the session.
- Was the password or the phone number changed before the first payment?
- Can the payments still be recalled?

Suggested next step: Call the customer on a known number, freeze the new device, reverse what can be reversed.

Finding: _____ Outcome: Confirmed fraud / Not fraud / Escalated Investigator and date: _____

Q-0007 · Card testing

P1 | Merchant M-0397 | 1 transactions | 1 account(s) | USD 3,297 | max score 996

Seen: 2026-09-07 06:58:18 to 2026-09-07 06:58:18. **Already confirmed:** 0. **Seen by the current rules:** 0.

Why it was raised: Accounts seen on this device; Amount against the largest so far; First payment to this payee.

Time	Account	Channel	Payee	USD	Ctry	IP	Device	Score
2026-09-07 06:58:18	A-02627	ecom	M-0397	3,297	SA	VN	D-T03	996

Source: tables/alert_queue.csv (1 transactions, 1 shown)

What to check

- Which cards were tested, and did any see a large purchase afterwards?
- Is the merchant itself compromised, or used as a test site?
- Does the acquirer see the same pattern elsewhere?

Suggested next step: Block the affected cards, ask the acquirer about the merchant, watch for large purchases on the tested cards.

Finding: _____ Outcome: Confirmed fraud / Not fraud / Escalated Investigator and date: _____

Q-0008 · Card testing

P1 | Merchant M-0410 | 45 transactions | 45 account(s) | USD 79 | max score 999

Seen: 2026-09-06 03:12:01 to 2026-09-06 05:05:30. **Already confirmed:** 10. **Seen by the current rules:** 0.

Why it was raised: Small amounts at this merchant (last hour); Accounts seen on this device; Accounts at this merchant (last hour); Small-amount burst at a merchant.

Time	Account	Channel	Payee	USD	Ctry	IP	Device	Score
2026-09-06 03:12:01	A-01269	ecom	M-0410	1	AE	VN	D-T03	993
2026-09-06 03:25:24	A-01849	ecom	M-0410	3	GB	VN	D-T03	997
2026-09-06 03:27:49	A-02336	ecom	M-0410	2	AE	VN	D-T03	997
2026-09-06 03:30:10	A-00047	ecom	M-0410	3	SA	VN	D-T03	998
2026-09-06 03:31:20	A-00227	ecom	M-0410	1	AE	VN	D-T03	997
2026-09-06 05:04:02	A-00465	ecom	M-0410	1	SA	VN	D-T03	998
2026-09-06 05:04:28	A-00245	ecom	M-0410	2	SA	VN	D-T03	998
2026-09-06 05:05:30	A-02085	ecom	M-0410	1	SA	VN	D-T03	999

Source: tables/alert_queue.csv (45 transactions, 8 shown)

What to check

- Which cards were tested, and did any see a large purchase afterwards?
- Is the merchant itself compromised, or used as a test site?
- Does the acquirer see the same pattern elsewhere?

Suggested next step: Block the affected cards, ask the acquirer about the merchant, watch for large purchases on the tested cards.

Finding: _____ Outcome: Confirmed fraud / Not fraud / Escalated Investigator and date: _____

Q-0009 · Unusual behaviour

P2 | Account A-00715 | 3 transactions | 1 account(s) | USD 29,475 | max score 962

Seen: 2026-09-05 14:44:38 to 2026-09-12 00:55:39. **Already confirmed:** 0. **Seen by the current rules:** 1.

Why it was raised: Value in the last 24 hours; Transactions in the last 24 hours; Amount against the largest so far; Transactions in the last hour.

Time	Account	Channel	Payee	USD	Ctry	IP	Device	Score
2026-09-05 14:44:38	A-00715	transfer	B-02419	28,031	SA	SA	D-000715	952
2026-09-08 13:06:41	A-00715	ecom	M-0054	390	SA	SA	D-000715	958
2026-09-12 00:55:39	A-00715	card_present	M-0026	1,054	SA	SA		962

Source: tables/alert_queue.csv (3 transactions, 3 shown)

What to check

- Is there a simple explanation in the account history?
- Does the customer recognise the payment?

Suggested next step: Review the account history; ask the customer if the payment is not explained.

Finding: _____ Outcome: Confirmed fraud / Not fraud / Escalated Investigator and date: _____

Q-0010 · Unusual behaviour

P2 | Account A-00817 | 2 transactions | 1 account(s) | USD 20,313 | max score 974

Seen: 2026-08-29 22:59:44 to 2026-09-30 13:04:07. **Already confirmed:** 0. **Seen by the current rules:** 2.

Why it was raised: Amount against the largest so far; Dormant days before this; Accounts paying this payee (7 days); First payment to this payee.

Time	Account	Channel	Payee	USD	Ctry	IP	Device	Score
2026-08-29 22:59:44	A-00817	ecom	M-0001	10,106	AE	AE	D-000817	970
2026-09-30 13:04:07	A-00817	ecom	M-0130	10,207	AE	AE	D-500817	974

Source: tables/alert_queue.csv (2 transactions, 2 shown)

What to check

- Is there a simple explanation in the account history?
- Does the customer recognise the payment?

Suggested next step: Review the account history; ask the customer if the payment is not explained.

Finding: _____ Outcome: Confirmed fraud / Not fraud / Escalated Investigator and date: _____

Limitations and assumptions

- The cases come from a score and from rules, not from an investigation. The facts here are what the data shows, not what happened.
- Confirm with sources outside this data before acting on a customer.
- Reporting decisions belong to the compliance officer.

Appendix

Data quality

Audit trail

Run ID	`fa_20261111T180052Z_f79efa`
Run started / finished (UTC)	2026-11-11T18:00:52+00:00
Analyst	info@proquantanalytics.com
Code version (git)	`2703b230a84f (uncommitted changes) · core 0.1.0`
Config SHA-256	`8191c3fc9de383b6`
Input: transactions	`100939 rows · sha256 59c79c357ce5872c`
Input: accounts	`3000 rows · sha256 9e6df748cb753a9c`
Input: merchants	`420 rows · sha256 43b8424681529e28`
Input: fx_rates	`734 rows · sha256 0d53d2d5aba20d07`
Input: alerts	`2592 rows · sha256 a5d41ff79cd234e5`
Input: cases	`546 rows · sha256 76d5257c1660ec05`
Environment	`python 3.13.5 · pandas 2.2.3 · numpy 2.1.3`

Source: audit.json in the run folder

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